

Chapter 177-10

Liang Shi's scalp went numb when she saw those photos. She didn't really want to click on them.

She didn't want to admit those were her at all.

These were all things Liang Xinzhou had dealt with before. Liang Shi never expected there would be a day when they'd be exposed.

But what happened had happened—it was hard to say it didn't exist.

What followed was a grand feeding frenzy of exposure.

Soon, Xu Qingzhu's identity was also dug up.

Netizens discovered Liang Shi's alternate account by going through Xu Qingzhu's previous livestreams.

Liang Shi's alternate account didn't really have anything on it—she just occasionally liked some movie promotional Weibo posts and such.

But it did confirm that Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu were married.

This made everyone's impression of Xu Qingzhu turn negative as well, so the first thing Xu Qingzhu did when she woke up was deal with the falling stock prices.

Liang Shi had a splitting headache.

But what was meant to come would always come.

Crisis PR also had its methods—make good use of the golden 24 hours and reverse the public opinion trend as quickly as possible.

The more disadvantaged you were, the calmer you needed to be.

What Liang Shi feared most right now was those people releasing the original host's bedroom photos—that really would be impossible to clear up.

Even solo bedroom photos would be somewhat acceptable, since the original host was single at the time. But she hoped there weren't photos from when the original host was into BDSM¹ and had certain addictions.

Otherwise... not even divine intervention could save her.

Especially since "Sharp Edge" had just been officially announced yesterday.

It was hard to say Guo Xinran wasn't involved in this.

But now wasn't the time to pursue the mastermind behind the scenes. The most important thing was to get through this crisis.

Liang Shi first confirmed the authenticity of these photos, then went to the company to meet with her agent to discuss how to handle this.

This trending search was different from all the previous ones. It was like it was premeditated, exposing all her disgraceful incidents. Countless marketing accounts came out in droves, all attacking one point: chaotic private life.

And suspected cheating.

If this were really the case, given everyone's fondness for Xu Qingzhu, they definitely wouldn't be able to tolerate her.

And Xu Qingzhu was already close to her due date...

Liang Shi was truly on high alert about this matter.

While she was at the company discussing with her agent how to handle things—

On the other side of the city, the Shen family was having breakfast together, all neat and tidy.

It had been a long time since they'd eaten breakfast together.

Shen Siyan and Shen Hui had the weekend off. Gu Yixue and Shen Fenghe had come home last night and hadn't gone to work yet this morning.

Shen Yaobo had just finished reading the financial newspaper and handed his reading glasses to the housekeeper. Zhu Mingqi then brought up the matter of everyone going on a trip together—they'd talked about it many times but never followed through. It had been three years since their last family outing.

Zhu Mingqi was coordinating everyone's schedules.

Shen Hui said she still hadn't taken her annual leave this year. Shen Siyan said she was available anytime, preferably during winter or summer break. Gu Yixue also had a flexible schedule. Everyone's eyes fell on Shen Fenghe.

Under the pressure, Shen Fenghe could only brace herself and say: "Around the middle of each month, the company is relatively less busy."

Only then did Zhu Mingqi beam with joy, patting her on the head: "That's Mama's good girl."

Shen Fenghe: "..."

She glanced at Gu Yixue and said awkwardly to Zhu Mingqi: "Mom, how old am I already?"

Zhu Mingqi said matter-of-factly: "No matter how old you are, you're still my daughter."

Shen Fenghe was helpless. She lowered her head to eat, but caught Gu Yixue secretly laughing out of the corner of her eye. She frowned and said coldly: "What are you laughing at?"

Zhu Mingqi heard this and lightly tapped her forehead with her chopsticks: "If you want to talk, just talk. Why are you being fierce with Xiaoxue? Eldest, let me tell you, this is how you make your wife angry."

"It's fine." Gu Yixue immediately came to Shen Fenghe's rescue. "Fenghe-jie just has this kind of personality."

"You just spoil her." Zhu Mingqi looked at Gu Yixue—the more she looked, the more beautiful she found her. "You two have been married for so long, and you're still calling her Fenghe-jie? Just call her by her name."

"Mom!" Shen Fenghe protested.

But Zhu Mingqi called out: "Husband!"

Shen Yaobo immediately looked toward Shen Fenghe, and Shen Fenghe gave up².

Shen Hui shook her head. "Tsk. Mom, can you change this habit of tattling?"

Zhu Mingqi scoffed: "If you have the ability, you tattle too."

Shen Hui: "...Childish."

Shen Siyan silently placed a fried egg on Shen Hui's plate.

Amid this "harmonious" atmosphere, Zhu Mingqi received a call from an unknown number.

Shen Hui and Gu Yixue were the type who liked browsing Weibo. They soon also saw the trending topics exploding one after another.

Gu Yixue sent a message to Liang Shi: 【Need help?】

Shen Hui took a screenshot and sent it to Zhao Xuning: 【Tsk, your good friend crashed and burned.】

Zhao Xuning replied instantly: 【You're really not going to help?】

Shen Hui: 【Why should I help?】

Zhao Xuning changed the subject: 【Have you eaten?】

Shen Hui: 【Eating right now.】

Zhao Xuning: 【I haven't eaten yet.】

Shen Hui: 【What does that have to do with me?】

Zhao Xuning: 【Wife... I'm hungry.】

Shen Hui: 【...】

Damn it.

After all these years, she still couldn't handle Zhao Xuning acting weak.

Shen Hui smiled as she tapped on the screen: 【Got it. I'll come eat with you in a bit.】

Zhao Xuning: 【I'm at your front door.】

Shen Hui: 【?】

She glanced out the window. Sure enough, there was a silver-white car parked outside the villa. She was just about to message Zhao Xuning saying she'd be right out when she heard Zhu Mingqi slam down her chopsticks and stand up, her voice sharp: "What do you mean?"

Footnotes:

¹ "Playing with letters" (玩字母) - Chinese internet slang that refers to BDSM activities. The "letters" refer to the English abbreviation BDSM (Bondage, Discipline, Sadism, Masochism). Combined with the mention of "addiction" (X癮, where X likely refers to 性/sex), this indicates the original host had been involved in such activities.

² "Gave up" (偃旗息鼓, yǎn qí xī gǔ) - Literally means "to lower the flags and silence the drums," a military idiom meaning to cease all activities or give up resistance. Here it means Shen Fenghe stopped protesting when her father looked at her.